

The Importance of Security Testing for Web and Mobile Apps

We live in the Smart Age today, with many of our daily activities being done for us by numerous 'intelligent' devices. This covers everything from simple tasks like adding two numbers, all the way to clicking on pictures of a black hole to learn more about it. The Internet is a new world, where there are tons of opportunities to explore, learn, grow and manage our lives better. Since much of what we do today is done by an app, the security of these apps is very important.



The Internet has empowered users to perform almost all their tasks (related to business, finance, commerce, shopping, development, domestic chores, etc) online. So in addition to websites, almost all companies now also have their own mobile apps.

These mobile apps and websites are extremely efficient, save time and make our daily tasks easy, be it turning the AC on or transferring funds from our bank account with just a simple touch on our smartphone. However, with so much of personal information being shared online, there are huge risks involved and valid concerns about data security.

On account of the criticality of the information being transferred, the security of these online transactions is more vital than ever before — not only to the end users but also to all the companies catering to them. That is why governments across the globe have stepped in, as did the European Union, with the introduction of the General Data Protection Regulation (GDPR) guidelines. This in turn has generated a huge need and demand for security testing for Web and mobile apps.

Apps can be classified as follows.

Web apps: These are built in pure HTML and served via a browser.

Native apps: These apps are built for a

specific OS or a platform that leverages that OS's features.

Hybrid apps: These apps, though installable and look native, behave like Web apps and make use of both native and Web app features.

Security testing

Security testing helps identify vulnerabilities in the code. It helps uncover various threats that may lead to malicious attacks from intruders trying to hamper the normal working of the app by stealing data, causing social media data leaks, or holding the system hostage by the use of ransomware. Therefore, this testing helps developers find vulnerabilities, and provides a robust solution in the code, preventing such attacks.

The key focus areas for security testing

Confidentiality: This is about disclosing information only to a specific group. This helps set limits in terms of access of information to a limited group, with permissions. One must test this area to ensure that only the designated person gets the information and that access is restricted to only those authorised to view the data in question.